GG EZ: Game Concept Brief

Checkpoint Game Jam 2026 (UNOCT and UNICRI with Global Game Jam), theme Play to Prevent. Team: Carl Kho (Philippines, based in San Francisco) and Dain Kim. Submitted 2026-10-31. Playable build and source: https://github.com/CarlKho-Minerva/gg-ez (Godot 4.7, runs in the browser).

1. One paragraph

You lose a fighting match by a hair. The stranger who beat you types "ez". You get three seconds and two replies. Most people type the cruel one. Lose three times and a RAGE QUIT button appears; press it and your controller goes through the screen, and on the other side of the crack is her room: a cheap desk in Quezon City at two in the morning, a night-shift call-centre lanyard, a phone with the rent due tomorrow. Then she queues again, and you get the same two replies. The game measures whether you change.

2. The feeling (decided 2026-10-25)

Moment	Feeling
First minute	Frustrated. Losing to someone better who is rubbing it in.
The turn	Recognition. You see who is on the other side.
A day later	Mid-match, you pause before typing.

The target behaviour is the blame reflex: the fast, automatic insult at whoever is nearest when something goes wrong. It is Carl's own habit from Philippine pisonets (pay-per-minute internet cafes) and LAN parties, and it is common in all four jam countries.

3. Why this is prevention (Theme Integration)

Nobody is radicalised in this game and nobody is recruited. The game is about the first rung. The organisers' PVE 101 webinar names harassment and toxicity as the leading sign that identity dynamics are hardening into us-versus-them; the Philippine police track "nihilistic" extremism, violence without an ideology, where other people have become non-player characters. Typing "ez" back to a stranger is the smallest version of that: a person reduced to a line of text. The game does three things with it.

1. The player does the harmful thing first. The match is rigged so that losing feels unfair (the finisher whiffs once, one input lags, she survives at 94 percent), and the reply window is three seconds. The cruel reply is designed to be the easy one.
2. Then the player has to go and look. The room and the phone are not a lecture. They are five objects and five text messages, in Tagalog with English under it, and the player clicks through them at their own pace. She is a victim of the same economy the player is in, not a threat, and nothing on the phone turns her into a plot.
3. Then the same choice again, with the same two buttons. The intervention is not a message on a screen; it is the second press. The game logs the reply and the time it took on every loop. It ends when the player picks the kind reply twice in a row after having seen the room, or when they log off from her room, or after eight losses.

Guards: her line is always small (“ez”, “gg ez”); she is never cruel. The player never investigates or confronts anyone. Nothing rewards “my side good, their side bad”. No religion, no politics, no real groups.

4. Know, think, feel, do

Know	Think	Feel	Do
The person behind “ez” has a life, and “it was just a game” lands on someone	“I don’t start it, I respond” becomes “my response was out of proportion”	Frustration, then recognition	Pause before typing; pick the other reply when you meet her again

5. The core loop (Prototype and Gameplay)

One loop is about 50 seconds and the game is built to be played several times in one sitting.

1. Match, 30 seconds. Side-view 2D arena, keyboard: move, jump, sword. Both fighters have a damage percent. The player’s hits land for 9 to 14 percent. At 90 percent three rigs fire once each: the player’s next swing whiffs, the next input is delayed, and she charges a finisher that cannot be survived. Her percent turns red and pulses when she is one hit from gone, so the player knows how close it was. Hit stop and screen shake on every landed hit.
2. KO. She types “ez”. Two replies for three seconds, with a countdown: “wow, you’re good” and “fuck you”. Silence is logged as “said nothing”.
3. Defeat card: REMATCH. After the third loss since the last room visit, RAGE QUIT appears beside it. After the fifth, the controller flies on its own.
4. Rage quit: the controller hits the screen, the screen cracks, the crack opens onto her room. Visit one shows the phone and two objects; every later visit adds one more.
5. Her side: her portrait, her screen with what the player actually typed, then “queue again”. Back to 1.
6. End card: every loss with the reply and the reply time. Then a three-question feedback form.

Controls are taught by doing: the game opens on three pixelised real clips (a Philippine street at night, a pisonet, a player at a screen), then asks for one move, one jump and one swing before the title.

6. Cultural relevance

Quezon City at 2 AM. A night-shift customer-care ID (10 PM to 7 AM), pancit canton from a cup at 2 AM, an electric fan because the air conditioner costs too much to run, a note about a qualifier whose prize is two months of rent. The phone messages are from a landlady, a mother and a team lead, in Tagalog with a translation beneath (“Kaka-computer mo yan”: that’s from all the computer). The pisonet (one peso buys five minutes) and the trash talk across the room are Carl’s own; Mobile Legends is the lunch-break game in Philippine high schools and is big across Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore. Her name is lia_ph.

7. What makes it ours (Creativity)

The rematch is the measurement. The same two buttons before and after the room turn the game into its own before-and-after test, logged per loop. The controller through the screen is the turn, and the

“ez” is deliberately tiny so that the player’s reaction is the only thing out of proportion. Real footage is pixelised into the game’s own style for the intro, so the real world and the fake game share one look.

8. Measuring impact

Every loss logs the reply, the reply time in milliseconds and whether the player rage quit. The result event carries the whole loop array and the end reason (nice twice, log off, or eight losses). A feedback form asks how it felt (1 to 5), whether they will pause next time someone types “ez” at them (yes, maybe, no), and anything else. Events go to PostHog when a key is set, and always to a local file.

9. Scope: jam build and after

Jam build (Oct 31): everything in section 5, in the browser. Two-month phase, if selected: a second opponent with a different life, voice for her lines, more phone messages, a proper art pass on the match, and a short before-and-after quiz.

10. Safety

Her line stays small. Anything the player types is never shown to another human. No weapons outside the fake match. No UN names or emblems.

11. AI use disclosure

Claude (Anthropic) wrote most of the Godot script from Carl and Dain’s design sessions and this brief’s drafts. Krea 2 Turbo (open weights, run locally) generated the sprites, portraits and the room picture from text prompts; the cut-outs were scripted. The intro footage is three Pexels clips (free licence, no attribution required), pixelised with ffmpeg. Sound effects are free-licence packs, listed in the credits.

12. Credits

Carl Kho: design, code, writing. Dain Kim: design, the ghost and the feeling. Footage: Pexels contributors (clips 15596316, 7915046). Sound: see assets/sfx/CREDITS.md in the repository.